

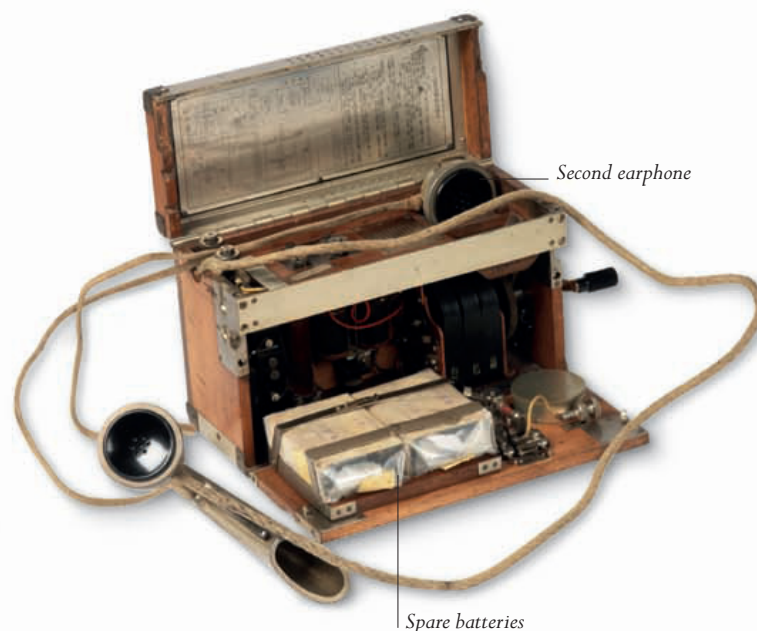
► TYPE EE-8-B US ARMY FIELD TELEPHONE

Date 1944

Origin US

Type Field telephone set

For security reasons, battlefield communication during the war, especially between rear-echelon command posts and front-line units, was still carried out by means of land lines rather than by radio wherever possible. This was to avoid the need for time-consuming encoding and decoding.



▲ FIELD TELEPHONE MODEL 92

Date 1932

Origin Japan

Type Field telephone set

Developed in peacetime by the Oki Electric Co, this field telephone was manufactured to a very high standard. The wooden case housed a generator, the headset, batteries, and spares. The Japanese employed the "ground return" system, which was both less secure and less reliable than using twin cables.

► KRYHA

Date 1920s–1940s

Origin Germany

Type Encoding/decoding device

Simpler in character than Enigma, Kryha was considerably less secure – a 1,135 characters-long test message was successfully broken by an American team within three hours. This purely mechanical device, however, had the advantage of being much smaller and lighter.



▼ TYPE A MK III SUITCASE RADIO TRANSCEIVER

Date 1944

Origin UK

Type Radio transceiver

This was the most widely used of the British "spy radios", and technically the best of them. It had a transmission range of over 800km (500 miles). Packed into a suitcase just 10cm (4in) deep, along with spares and accessories, it weighed only 4kg (8½lb) in total.

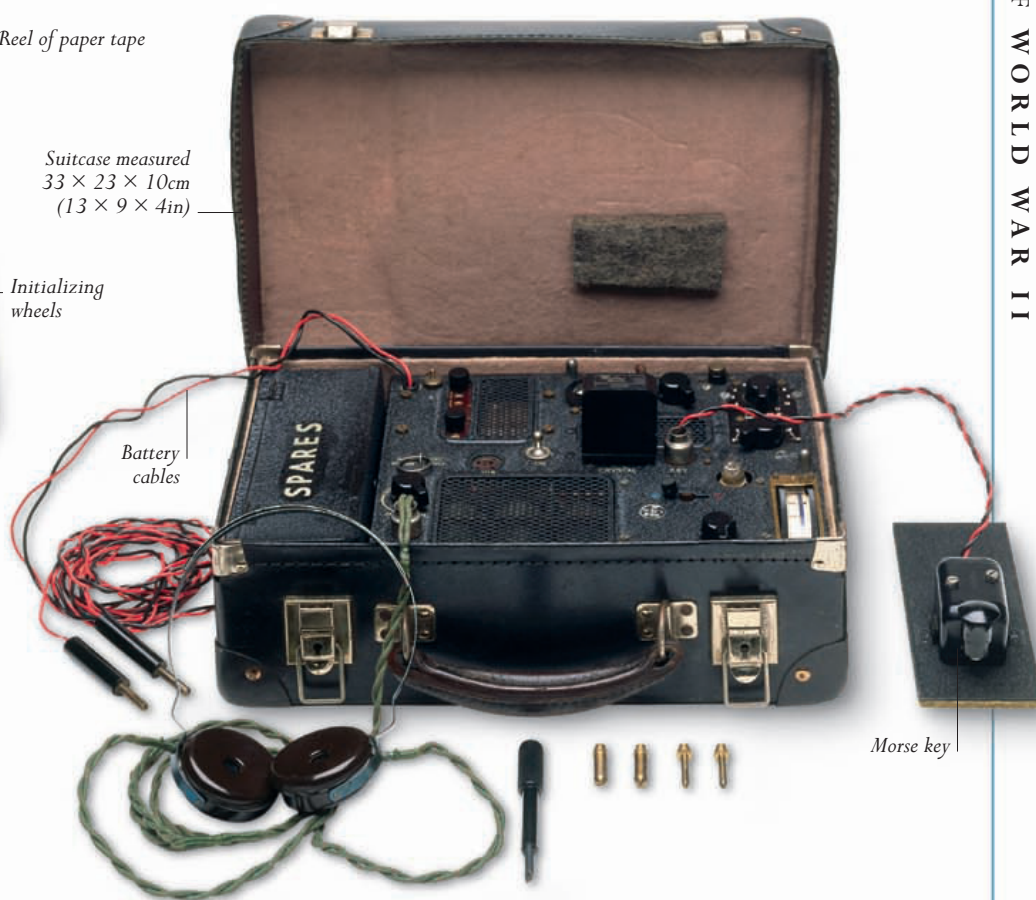
Spare valve



Suitcase measured
33 × 23 × 10cm
(13 × 9 × 4in)

Initializing wheels

Battery cables



▲ M209B

Date 1940–1955

Origin US

Type Encoding/decoding device

A purely mechanical encryption device, the M209 employed six alphabetic wheels to set up the initial key. The message was then entered one character at a time via the wheel on the left. The result was printed on paper tape, and the rotor settings advanced. Reversing the procedure permitted decoding. M209's output was decoded by German code-breakers by early 1943.